

Mac OS X by Serif. Serif's new product was aimed at creative professionals and was created on an entirely new codebase determined to match Adobe Illustrator which obviously implies that Affinity Designer can take full advantage of the latest hardware.

At \$50, it's the same price as one month's subscription of Illustrator and almost half of that of its competitors like Sketch. Although it's primarily a vector graphics app, it can also edit pixel based images. Another feature is adding raster layer or "layer masks" on top of your vector images. The absence of the artboards option bothers us a little though. It's pretty fast – most other editors seem slow and clunky in comparison. It is surprisingly full featured and the supported input and output options are more than satisfactory. All of this makes us declare it the second best proprietary software after Illustrator.

Sketch 3

This graphics editor by Bohemian Graphics has, in the past, disappointed and is widely believed to be insufficient as a professional grade graphics editor. But let's not forget that they've been working on consecutive iterations for six years now, which makes them old hands in web years. Sketch is a stable editor with relatively few bugs and not much to complain about. It's also disappointing that it's only available for Mac but then again, it's cheaper than many of its competitors at \$100.

Open Source Software

Inkscape

This open source software has potential to produce anything from simple logos to more complex graphics. What we admire the most about it is the wide palette of drawing tools. Intended and created as a no-cost alternative to Illustrator, Inkscape uses the W3C standard Scalable Vector Graphics(SVG) format for its files. Its intuitive interface is great for beginning freelancers and small businesses although the lag really got on our nerves. Runs on Windows, Mac and Linux. We declare it the best open source vector graphics editor.



Apache OpenOffice DRAW

This open source software is available for Mac, Windows and Linux operating systems. It has a rich feature set and good user support system but